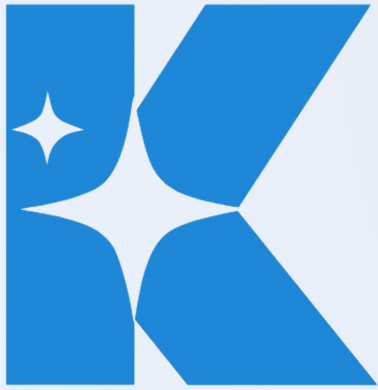




BEFORE Q4 HITS

38 firms a day close over late payments. Fix this first.

Government research puts the toll at 14,000 UK businesses a year. Here is the one process we would fix before your busiest quarter.

[SWIPE >>](#)



01 / 06

Pick the process that breaks first when volume doubles

Ask which job makes you stay late in a busy week. For most small firms it is getting paid: raising invoices, then chasing them. Fix that one, not five.

START WITH

Write down the one task that backed up worst last December.



02 / 06

Put the steps on one page

Who raises the invoice, when it goes, who chases and on which day. If it lives in one person's head, it breaks the week they are off sick.

START WITH

List every step from finished job to money in the bank.



03 / 06

Invoice the day the work is done

Every day you wait is a day added to the payment clock. Put the due date and your terms on the invoice itself, in writing, every time.

START WITH

Send today's invoice before you close the laptop.



04 / 06

Let software send the reminders

Xero, QuickBooks and most accounting tools can email a reminder before the due date, on it and a week after. The trade-off: automated nudges can feel cold, so call your biggest customers yourself.

START WITH

Switch on automatic reminders for your smaller accounts.



05 / 06

Know what the law already lets you do

You can already charge statutory interest and a fixed fee on late commercial invoices. A Bill now in the Lords proposes a 60-day cap and new powers for the Small Business Commissioner. It is not law yet, so do not rely on it.

START WITH

Add a late-payment interest line to your standard terms.



06 / 06

Time one week before the rush

Count the hours the process eats this week. Government research puts the average affected firm at 86 hours a year chasing money it is already owed. Beat your own number before December, not after.

START WITH

Log your chasing time for seven days and keep the total.



Fix one process. Before the rush.

We would start with getting paid. It is dull, it is measurable, and it decides whether a busy quarter turns into cash or into a pile of unpaid invoices.

**Which process in your business
breaks first when things get busy?**